

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DNR

Date: 5/21/2026

Bill Number: HB79

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): VIC FISCHER MARINE PARK; RESEARCH PROGRAM

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☐ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

The Department has no position on this legislation.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

The bill makes two naming changes in Alaska law:

1. Renames the Institute of Social and Economic Research (ISER) at the University of Alaska to the Vic Fischer Institute of Social and Economic Research
- 2.
3. Names the marine park unit at Shoup Bay the Vic Fischer Shoup Bay State Marine Park

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Why Is This Bill Needed?

The bill is a commemorative/honorary measure intended to honor Vic Fischer, a notable Alaskan figure.

How Does It Change Department Programs?

Changes are minimal and administrative in nature:

- AS 14.40.110 is amended to formally rename ISER within University of Alaska statute
- AS 41.21.304 is amended to assign an official name to the Shoup Bay marine park unit
- Notably, the bill explicitly prohibits the University of Alaska from spending funds on signage or materials solely to reflect the new name, limiting any administrative burden

Anticipated Impact

- Public: Minimal direct impact. The Shoup Bay park naming may carry cultural/historical significance for Alaskans familiar with Fischer's legacy
- Private Sector: No discernible impact
- University of Alaska: Nominal — the name change is effectively unfunded

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1 — Legislative Intent (Uncodified)

Statutory Reference: Uncodified law of the State of Alaska

This section establishes legislative intent regarding fiscal responsibility in implementing the rename. Specifically, it prohibits the University of Alaska from expending funds on signage or materials exclusively to update the name of the Vic Fischer Institute of Social and Economic Research.

Section 2 — Renaming of the Institute (Codified)

Statutory Reference: AS 14.40.110 — Establishment of Business, Economics, and Public Administration Research Program

This section amends existing statute to formally rename the University of Alaska's research institute. The existing statutory language establishing the "Business, Economics, and Public Administration Research Program" is retained, but the institute's operational name is changed to the Vic Fischer Institute of Social and Economic Research.

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Section 3 — Naming of Shoup Bay State Marine Park (Codified)

Statutory Reference: AS 41.21.304 — amended by adding a new subsection (b)

This section adds a new subsection to existing statute to formally assign the name Vic Fischer Shoup Bay State Marine Park to the marine park unit designated under AS 41.21.304(a)(4).

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

Senator Dunbar added Section 1 and 2 to existing bill on 3/13/26.

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

City of Valdez, Susan Alleroth, documented written support.

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

None noted.

Commissioner’s Signature:  Date: 5/21/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor’s Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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